

Shahzaib Ahmed

Mobile Application Security Engineer

shahxaibx21@gmail.com

linkedin.com/in/shahzaib-ahmed-81484b262

github.com/shahxaibx21-code

+92 345 2610083

Islamabad, Islamabad Capital Territory, PK

Mobile Application Security Engineer with 7+ years of multidisciplinary experience across technology, research, education, and digital services, now specializing in authorized Android application security, REST and GraphQL API security testing, and vulnerability assessment. I help developers and organizations identify and fix security weaknesses in Android apps and backend APIs through APK analysis, authorized reverse engineering, and structured static and dynamic testing, benchmarked against OWASP MASVS, Mobile Top 10, and API Security Top 10. My approach is authorization-first, methodical, and report-driven.

Work Experience

Mobile Application Security Consultant

Sep 2021 - Present

Systems Limited | Islamabad, Pakistan (Remote)

- Provide authorized security assessments for Android applications and backend APIs, identifying confirmed vulnerabilities and delivering practical remediation guidance.
- Perform Android application and REST/GraphQL API security testing using structured static analysis, dynamic testing, and manual verification.
- Conduct APK analysis and authorized reverse engineering with Frida, Ghidra, JADX, MobSF, and Burp Suite to uncover authentication, authorization, and business-logic flaws.
- Review insecure data storage, network security, and application configuration against OWASP MASVS, Mobile Top 10, and API Security Top 10.
- Reproduce and validate findings with tailored Frida hooks, Python automation, and custom scripts to demonstrate real-world exploitability.
- Collaborate with development teams to retest fixes and confirm remediation before release.
- Deliver risk-prioritized reports with supporting evidence and remediation guidance to developers and stakeholders.

Freelance Security Researcher

2019 - 2021

Independent / Contract | Remote

- Delivered independent penetration testing and vulnerability assessments for web and mobile applications for startups and small teams.
- Built hands-on expertise in reverse engineering, API testing, and secure-code review while earning the Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH) certification.
- Automated recurring test workflows with Python to speed up assessment and reporting.
- Produced clear, actionable security reports covering findings, impact, and remediation steps.

Web Developer & Digital Services

2017 - 2019

Freelance | Remote

- Built and maintained responsive websites and digital solutions using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and PHP alongside university studies.
- Gained a foundation in web technologies, databases, and application architecture that later informed security work.
- Worked directly with clients to gather requirements, deliver projects, and provide ongoing support.

Projects

Reverse-Engineering a Private API

github.com/shahxaibx21-code

Discovered a critical flaw in a major mobile app (1,000,000,000+ installs) — a private endpoint exposed via a custom binary protocol with no authentication. Built a proof-of-concept and reported it with remediation guidance.

SSL Pinning Bypass with Frida

github.com/shahxaibx21-code

Frida scripts to bypass SSL/TLS certificate pinning and root/emulator detection on Android apps, enabling authorized traffic interception and analysis.

Android APK Static Analyzer

github.com/shahxaibx21-code

Python tooling that automates APK decompilation and static analysis to surface hardcoded secrets, insecure configurations, and risky permissions.

Mobile API Fuzzer

github.com/shahxaibx21-code

Automated fuzzing harness for REST/GraphQL mobile backends to test authentication, authorization, rate-limiting, and data-exposure controls.

OWASP MASVS Assessment Toolkit

github.com/shahxaibx21-code

Checklist-driven toolkit mapping findings to OWASP MASVS and Mobile Top 10 for consistent, repeatable mobile security reviews.

Core Skills

Application Security • Mobile Application Security

Application Security, Mobile Application Security, Android Application Security, Android Security, Mobile Penetration Testing, Penetration Testing, Mobile Security Testing, Secure Authentication, Authentication Systems, Authorization, Access Control, Secure Coding, Insecure Data Storage Review, Business-Logic Testing

API Security

API Security, API Penetration Testing, REST APIs, GraphQL, API Endpoint Testing, Mobile API Fuzzing & Automation

Reverse Engineering & Analysis

Reverse Engineering, Android Reverse Engineering, APK Analysis, Static Application Security Testing (SAST), Dynamic Application Security Testing (DAST), Cryptography, Source Intelligence (OSINT), Data Analysis

Assessment, Standards & Reporting

Vulnerability Assessment, Vulnerability Management, Threat Modeling, Risk Assessment, Security Testing, Network Security, OWASP MASVS, OWASP Mobile Top 10, OWASP API Security Top 10, Technical Documentation, Technical Communication

Tools & Programming

Frida, Objection, Burp Suite, Ghidra, JADX, MobSF, Postman, Android Studio, Android Debug Bridge (ADB), Automation, Python, Java, Kotlin, Bash

Education

University of Management and Technology (UMT)

Sep 2015 - Sep 2019

Bachelor of Science (BS) — Cyber/Computer Forensics and Counterterrorism

Languages

English (Professional), Urdu (Native)

Certificates

Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH)

EC-Council • Issued Mar 2021